Frankenstein Friday Reading and Activity Sheet, Oct. 30, 2026

Mary Shelley's Frankenstein; or, The Modern Prometheus (1818), for readers, classes and book clubs

KNOW THE STORY

- [ ] Summer near Lake Geneva: Byron proposes a ghost-story contest; Mary, 18, has a waking dream — 1816
- [ ] Frankenstein appears anonymously, in three volumes — 1818
- [ ] A London play, Presumption, turns the creature into a speechless brute — 1823
- [ ] Revised edition with Shelley's new preface — 1831
- [ ] Universal's film, with Boris Karloff as the monster — 1931

READ

- [ ] Read Walton's four letters to his sister, Mrs. Saville — Start
- [ ] Read the chapter where the creature first opens its eye — Then
- [ ] Read the creature's own story of learning to speak and read — Then

DISCUSS

- [ ] What does Victor owe the being he made, and does he pay it? — Q1
- [ ] Why does the creature turn violent? Point to his own words — Q2
- [ ] Why might Shelley never give the creature a name? — Q3
- [ ] Who is the real monster: the maker, the creature, or the people who reject him? — Q4

BOOK OR FILM?

- [ ] The creature talks, reads Paradise Lost and argues — Book
- [ ] A grunting brute; in 1931, stiff, machine-like steps — Films
- [ ] No name; called creature, fiend, monster, wretch, daemon — Book
- [ ] Often just called Frankenstein — Films

My thoughts, or a drawing of my own creature

Source: U.S. National Library of Medicine exhibition Frankenstein: Penetrating the Secrets of Nature; Project Gutenberg 1818 text (eBook 41445). Free texts: gutenberg.org/ebooks/41445 (1818) and 42324 (1831).